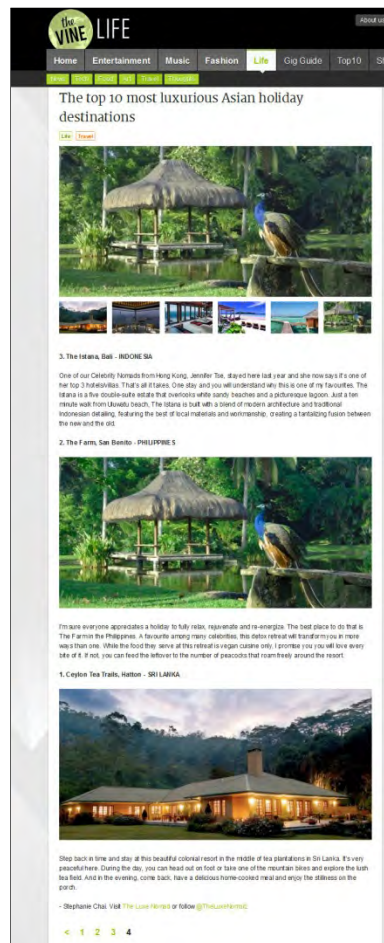
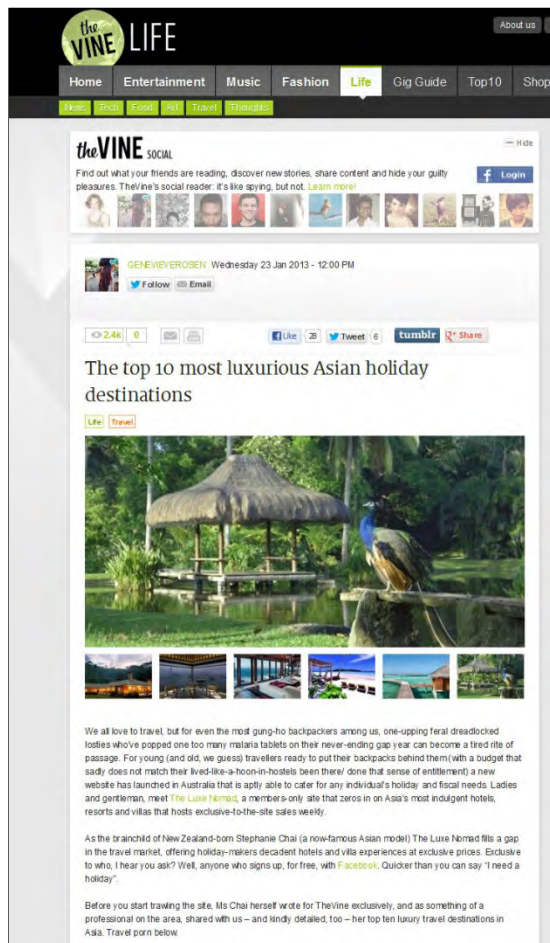


# THEVINE.COM.AU – THE ISTANA

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## The top 10 most luxurious Asian holiday destinations

By Genevieve Rosen

We all love to travel, but for even the most gung-ho backpackers among us, one-upping feral dreadlocked losties who've popped one too many malaria tablets on their never-ending gap year can become a tired rite of passage. For young (and old, we guess) travellers ready to put their backpacks behind them (with a budget that sadly does not match their lived-like-a-hoon-in-hostels been there/ done that sense of entitlement) a new website has launched in Australia that is aptly able to cater for any individual's holiday and fiscal needs. Ladies and gentleman, meet [The Luxe Nomad](#), a members-only site that zeros in on Asia's most indulgent hotels, resorts and villas that hosts exclusive-to-the-site sales weekly.

As the brainchild of New Zealand-born Stephanie Chai (a now-famous Asian model) The Luxe Nomad fills a gap in the travel market, offering holiday-makers decadent hotels and villa experiences at exclusive prices. Exclusive to who, I hear you ask? Well, anyone who signs up, for free, with [Facebook](#). Quicker than you can say "I need a holiday".

Before you start trawling the site, Ms Chai herself wrote for TheVine exclusively, and as something of a professional on the area, shared with us – and kindly detailed, too – her top ten luxury travel destinations in Asia. Travel porn below.

### **3. The Istana, Bali - INDONESIA**

One of our Celebrity Nomads from Hong Kong, Jennifer Tse, stayed here last year and she now says it's one of her top 3 hotels/villas. That's all it takes. One stay and you will understand why this is one of my favourites. The Istana is a five double-suite estate that overlooks white sandy beaches and a picturesque lagoon. Just a ten minute walk from Uluwatu beach, The Istana is built with a blend of modern architecture and traditional Indonesian detailing, featuring the best of local materials and workmanship, creating a tantalizing fusion between the new and the old.

[www.theistana.com](http://www.theistana.com)